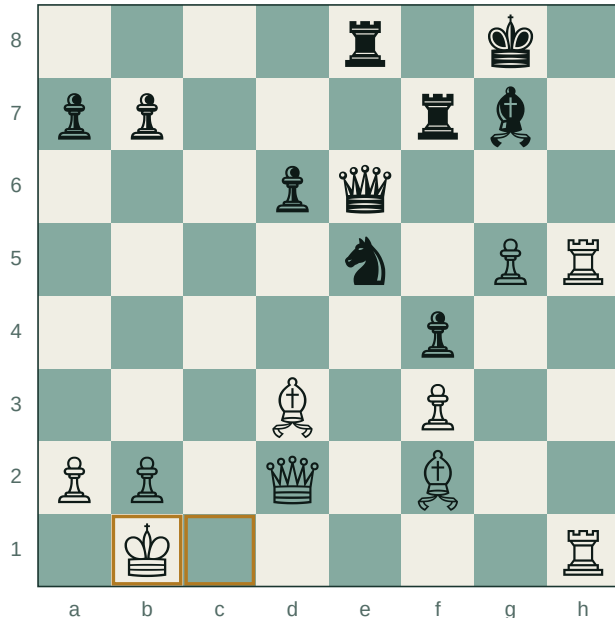


Clearance tactics: Black, move 29

Clearance tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 29.Kb1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

29...Nxd3 30. Qxd3 Qe2 31. Qb3 Qxf2

29...Nxd3 The knight captures the bishop on d3. Recorded reply: **30.Qxd3**.

30...Qe2 The queen moves from e6 to e2. From e2 it attacks queen on d3 and bishop on f2. Recorded reply: **31.Qb3**.

31...Qxf2 The queen captures the bishop on f2.

At the end, nominal material is White 23 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on b1. Geometrically undefended: queen on d2. Check for tactical protection.